Case Study

MS Add-on for Document Creation

Overview

The Document Creation Add-On for Microsoft Word is a cutting-edge tool specifically designed for users in the legal sector, particularly those working on MS Windows operating systems. This add-on enables legal and business processing professionals to easily create a variety of legal documents — ranging from simple templates to complex contractual agreements — without requiring any coding expertise. The system is built to streamline the document generation process, and engage in a seamless integration with data sources. The primary goal is to empower legal teams and professionals to work more efficiently, ensure compliance, and minimise errors.

Employer

HighQ / Thomson Reuters

Role

Senior Product Designer collaborating with a Senior Product Owner and an offshore development team in India.

Problem statement

A problem statement in simple term is a combination of Persona + Action + Barrier + Emotion

> **Despite the availability of the existing mail merge feature in Microsoft Word, legal professionals in law firms face significant challenges when generating complex legal documents. Users often struggle with time-consuming processes, a lack of intuitive UI tailored for legal needs, and difficulties in merging various data sets without the required technical proficiency. As a result, document creation becomes inefficient and prone to errors.**

Target users

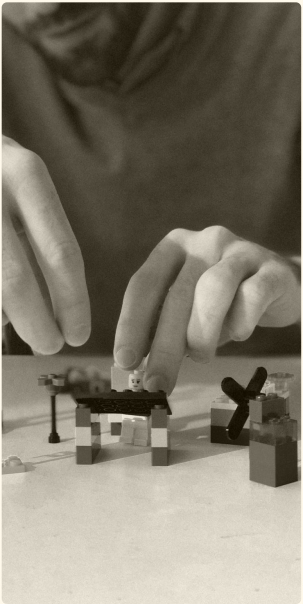
- **Legal and Business Processing Users:** Individuals who handle document creation and management in law firms, focusing on streamlining workflows.
- **Legal Partners:** Legal professionals and consultants who collaborate with law firms, needing to generate diverse legal documents effectively and accurately.

Scope

- Live synchronisation with the database (iSheet).
- Connection to a single client instance with multiple database support (iSheet).
- Implementation of loops and nested conditions for document generation.
- Permission-based data access to ensure confidentiality and compliance.
- Validation processes and live document previews to enhance user experience.
- Development of a very simple and intuitive user interface.

Constraints

- Reliance on existing Microsoft Word architecture and functionalities.
- Integration limitations with varying database types and configurations.
- A need for extensive user training or documentation to minimise the learning curve for users unfamiliar with the add-on.



UX Plan

Objective

- To create an intuitive and efficient document creation add-on for legal professionals that simplifies the workflow and reduces document generation time.

Goals

- To enhance user satisfaction and decrease document creation time by 40%.
- To deliver an interface that increases usability by ensuring intuitive navigation and access to features.
- To provide robust validation and preview features that eliminate errors before finalising documents.

UX Plan

Research Methods

- **Contextual Inquiry** (qualitative insights into user experiences).
  - A total of 6 users involved in contextual inquiry.
  How it is done:
    - Prepare • Visit site • Observe and Dialogue and • Document
- **Persona Creation:** Developed personas that represent core user profiles and their needs based on research.
- **User interviews** - A total of 10 users participated in structured or semi-structured interviews.
  How it is done:
    - Select • Structure interview (open ended questions) • Conduct Interview (max 1 hr) and • Analyse (Record and analyse the transcripts)
- **Usability testing** (evaluate effectiveness and efficiency of the prototype). - A total of 8 users participated in the usability testing sessions. These users were selected from a pool of participants who had participated in interviews, ensuring that they had a foundational understanding of document creation.

UX Plan

Timeline (12 weeks)

Week 1-2
Discover: Contextual Inquiry and User Interviews

Week 3-4
Define: Analysis of Research Findings and Persona Creation

Week 5-6
Ideate: Brainstorm Solutions Through Collaborative Sessions

Week 7-8
Design: Create Wireframes and UI Prototypes

Week 9-10
Test: User Testing and Gathering Feedback

Week 11-12
Handover: Final Adjustments and Collaboration with Development Teams

Week 1
DATE:
TO DO LIST:
NOTES & REMINDERS:
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UX Plan

Deliverables

- ↘ User personas.
- ↘ Empathy maps.
- ↘ Wireframes and interactive prototypes.
- ↘ Usability testing reports.
- ↘ Intuitive UI Design.

Design process

5D process

What to do?
- Stakeholder interviews
- Competitive audit
- Content audit
- Task analysis
- User surveys
- User interviews
- Personas

Discover →

What to do?
- Value proposition
- KPIs
- User stories
- Storyboards
- User journey map
- User experience map

Define →

What to do?
- Sketches
- Wireframes
- Prototypes
- User testing

Design (Sketch, Check, Build) →

What to do?
- Structural/Dynamic markups
- Scripts
- Style sheets
- Pattern library
- Style guide

Develop →

What to do?
- Heuristic analysis
- Metrics analysis
- Improvement plan
- Enhancement plan

Deploy & Measure

Vision
Analysis
Code
Learn

- Business goals
- Business requirements
- Technical constraints
- User information

- Product flow
- Information architecture
- User experience

- Layout design
- Interaction design
- Visual/Icon design

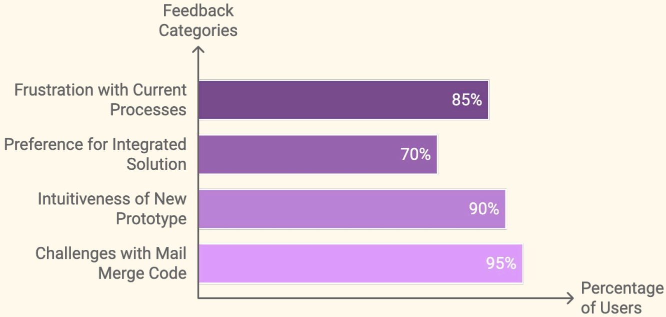
- Working product

- User feedback
- Bug reports
- Stats and Analytics

Observations

A comprehensive overview of the observations gathered from different sources

- ↘ 85% of users expressed frustration with current document generation processes, citing time inefficiencies and high error rates. (Contextual Inquiry)
- ↘ 70% of participants indicated that they would prefer a solution that integrates directly with their existing workflows without requiring extensive training. (User Interview)
- ↘ After initial testing, 90% of users found the new prototype to be more intuitive than their current methodologies, highlighting the effectiveness of the new design approach. (User Testing)
- ↘ 95% faced challenges in understanding and being forced to learn Mail merge (Velocity) code. (User Interview)


Feedback Categories
Frustration with Current Processes
85%
Preference for Integrated Solution
70%
Intuitiveness of New Prototype
90%
Challenges with Mail Merge Code
95%
Percentage of Users

User Feedback on Document Generation Processes

Persona

Legal Process Manager

Cameron Williamson, Age 34

A strategic professional responsible for overseeing and optimizing the legal operations within an organisation. They work closely with legal teams to streamline processes, enhance efficiency, and ensure compliance with regulations.

Goals

- Increase efficiency in document creation.
- Ensure compliance with legal standards.
- Streamline collaboration among team members.
- Reduce the training time for new tools.

Challenges

- Managing multiple revisions and versions of legal documents.
- Difficulty in accessing and managing multiple databases.
- Pressure to meet tight deadlines.

Motivations

- Deliver accurate legal documents promptly.
- Foster a collaborative work environment.
- Leverage technology to simplify processes.

Personality/Technology Proficiency

- Skilled at prioritising tasks, able to navigate tight deadlines while maintaining a focus on quality and compliance.
- Shows exceptional attention to detail, crucial for reviewing intricate legal documents and ensuring accuracy in compliance.
- Tends to be cautious when adopting new technologies, preferring to stick with familiar tools that have proven effective.

Persona

Legal Counsel

Tynisha Obey, Age 40

A seasoned attorney specialising in various aspects of law, such as corporate, intellectual property, or employment law. Work closely with clients providing tailored guidance involving drafting, reviewing, and finalising a wide array of legal documents, legal writing, etc.

Goals

- Generate various legal documents quickly and efficiently.
- Ensure client confidentiality and data security.

Challenges

- Balancing multiple clients and deadlines.
- Navigating complex legal requirements for document generation.

- Maintain consistency in legal language and formatting.
- Stay updated with evolving legal practices.

- Learning new software alongside time-sensitive work.

Motivations

- Enhance professional reputation through efficient service delivery.
- Minimise errors in legal documents to protect clients.
- Utilise technology for better document management.

Personality/Technology Proficiency

- Pays close attention to language, grammar, and formatting to ensure legal precision and clarity.
- Capable of breaking down complex legal issues and synthesising information into coherent documents.
- Values collaboration with paralegals and support staff to streamline processes and improve workflow efficiency.

Empathy Map

Legal Process Manager

Says

- I need a tool that integrates seamlessly with what we already use.
- Document creation takes far too long with our current methods.

Feels

- Frustrated with inefficiencies.
- Overwhelmed during peak periods.

Cameron Williamson

Does

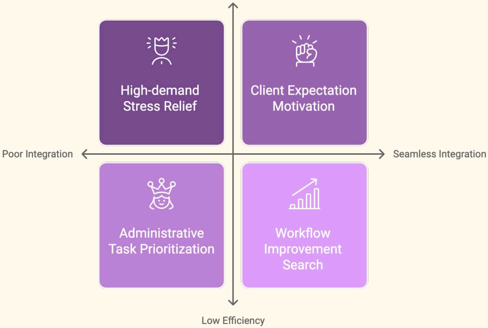
- Spend hours managing documents and versions.
- Collaborate with team members to resolve issues.

Thinks

- There has to be a better way to do this.
- I wish I could automate repetitive tasks.

Workflow Improvement Priorities

High Efficiency


High-demand Stress Relief
Client Expectation Motivation
Poor Integration
Seamless Integration
Administrative Task Prioritization
Workflow Improvement Search
Low Efficiency

Empathy Map

Legal Counsel

Says

- I need to focus on my clients, not on document formatting.
- Time is of the essence; I can't afford mistakes.

Feels

- Stressed during high-demand periods.
- Motivated to meet client expectations.

Tynisha Obey

Does

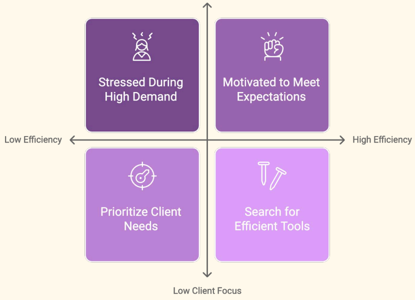
- Prioritise client needs over administrative tasks.
- Search for tools that help cut down on time-consuming processes.

Thinks

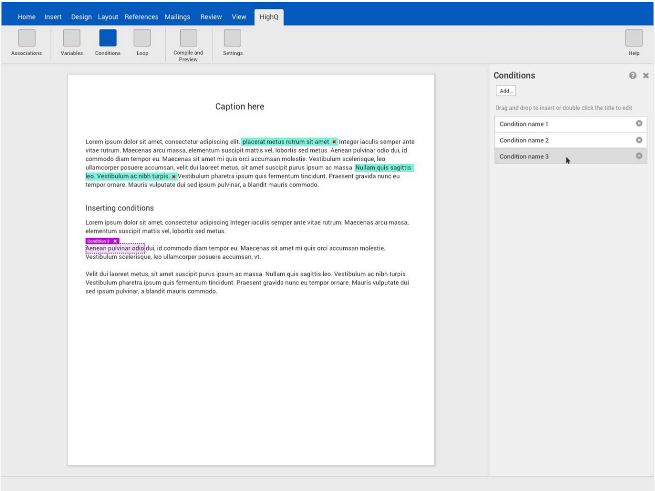
- How can I improve my workflow?
- Tech should help me, not complicate my work.

Workflow Prioritization and Tool Efficiency

High Client Focus


Stressed During High Demand
Motivated to Meet Expectations
Low Efficiency
High Efficiency
Prioritize Client Needs
Search for Efficient Tools
Low Client Focus

Sample works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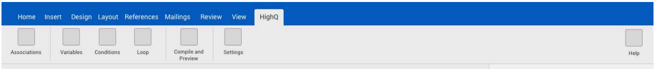
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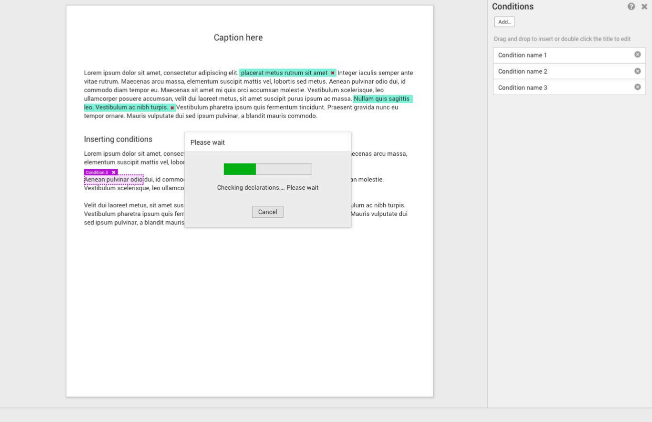

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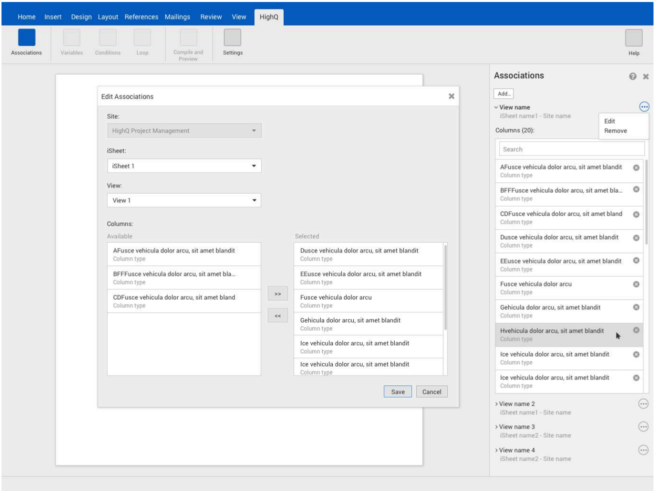

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Edit Associations

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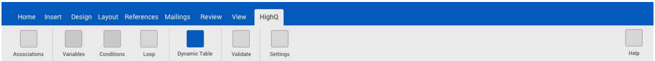

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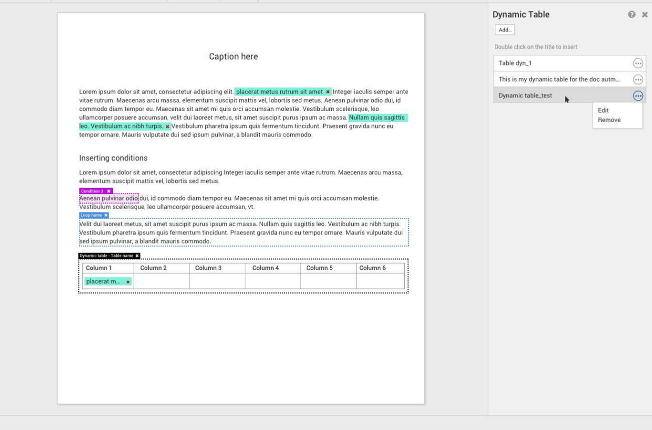
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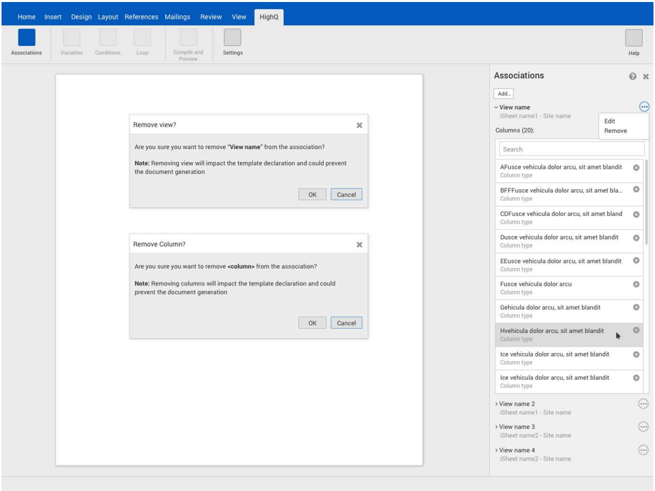
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Remove view?

Are you sure you want to remove "**View name**" from the association?

Note: Removing view will impact the template declaration and could prevent the document generation

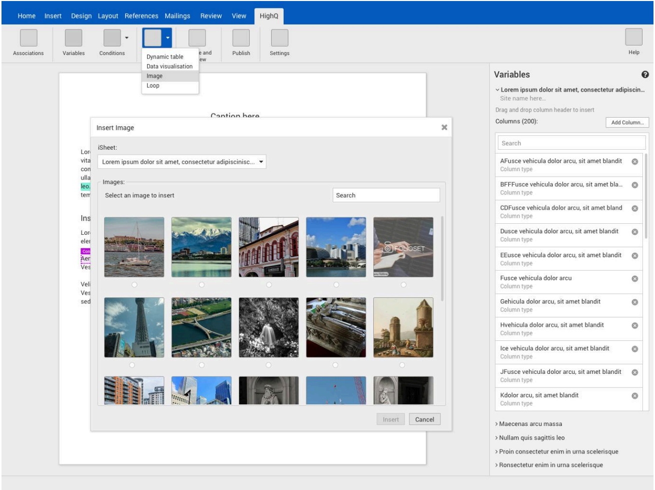
OK Cancel

Remove Column?

Are you sure you want to remove **<column>** from the association?

Note: Removing columns will impact the template declaration and could prevent the document generation

OK Cancel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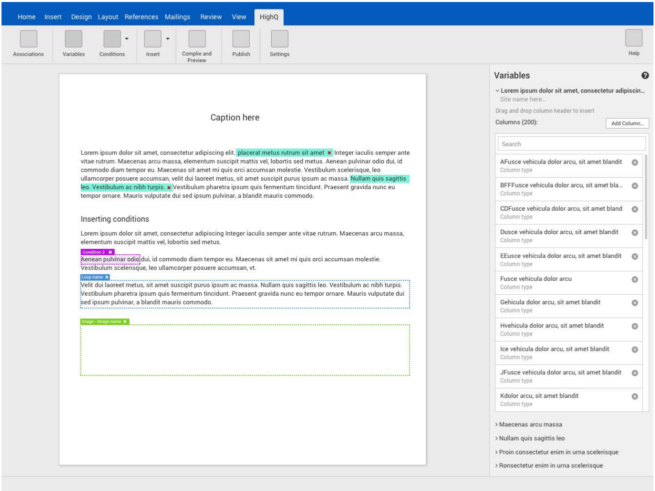
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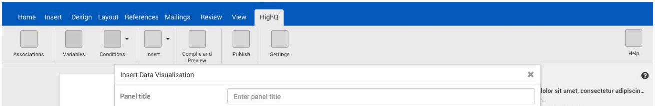
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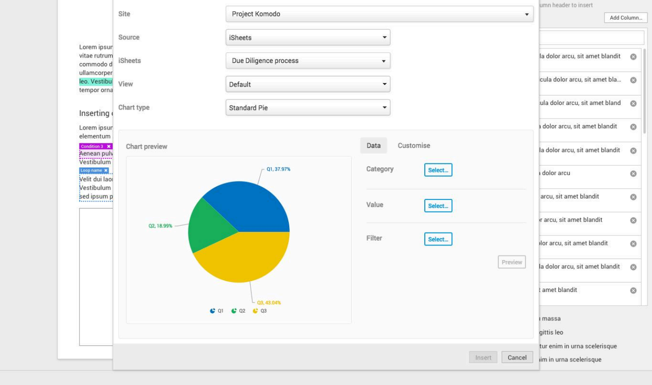

Site: Project Komodo

Source: iSheets

iSheets: Due Diligence process

View: Default

Chart type: Standard Pie

Chart preview
Q1, 37.97%
Q2, 18.99%
Q3, 43.04%
Q1
Q2
Q3
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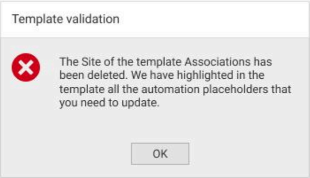
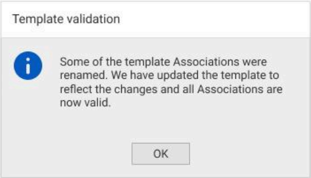
Customise
Category
Select...
Value
Select...
Filter
Select...
Preview
Insert
Cancel
Add Column...
Condition 3
Loop name



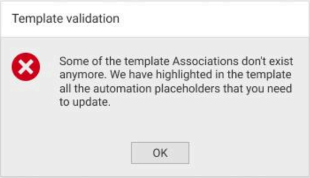
Template validation

The Site of the template Associations has been deleted. We have highlighted in the template all the automation placeholders that you need to update.



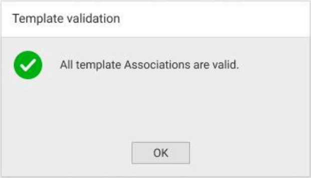
Template validation

Some of the template Associations were renamed. We have updated the template to reflect the changes and all Associations are now valid.



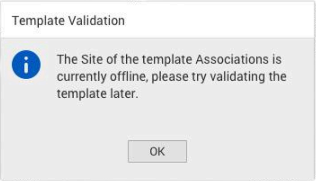
Template validation

Some of the template Associations don't exist anymore. We have highlighted in the template all the automation placeholders that you need to update.



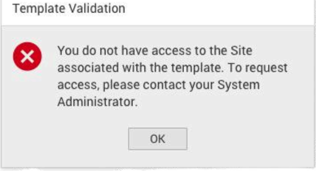
Template validation

All template Associations are valid.



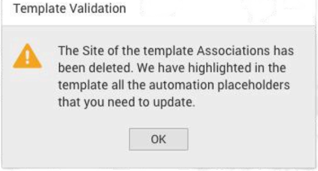
Template Validation

The Site of the template Associations is currently offline, please try validating the template later.



Template Validation

You do not have access to the Site associated with the template. To request access, please contact your System Administrator.



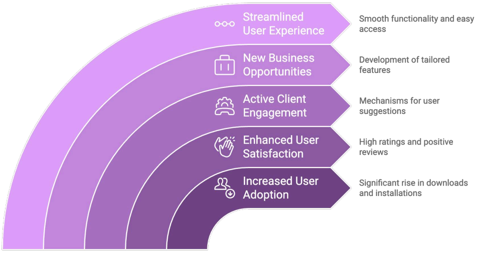
Template Validation

The Site of the template Associations has been deleted. We have highlighted in the template all the automation placeholders that you need to update.

Outcome

- **Increased User Adoption:** Significant rise in the number of users downloading and installing the add-on.
- **Enhanced User Satisfaction:** Accumulation of high ratings and positive user reviews on platforms and forums as well as reports of increased efficiency in document creation, resulting in user perceptions of the tool being indispensable.
- **Active Client Engagement:** Mechanisms for users to provide suggestions for future updates, leading to an ongoing dialogue.
- **New Business Opportunities:** Development of tailored features or services for businesses, driving bespoke solutions.
- **Streamlined User Experience:** Smooth functionality that allows users to work without interruption and easily access features.
- **Market Position and Brand Enhancement:** Articles or blogs highlighting the add-on as an innovative tool, elevating brand visibility.

Key Success Factors for Add-on



Streamlined User Experience
Smooth functionality and easy access
New Business Opportunities
Development of tailored features
Active Client Engagement
Mechanisms for user suggestions
Enhanced User Satisfaction
High ratings and positive reviews
Increased User Adoption
Significant rise in downloads and installations

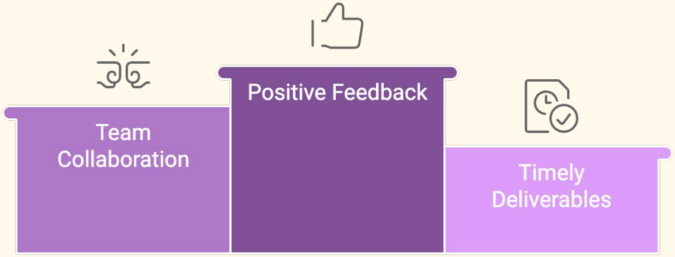
Learnings

What Went Well

- The prototype testing garnered overwhelmingly positive feedback, validating our design assumptions.

- Efficient collaboration between the design and development teams led to timely deliverables.

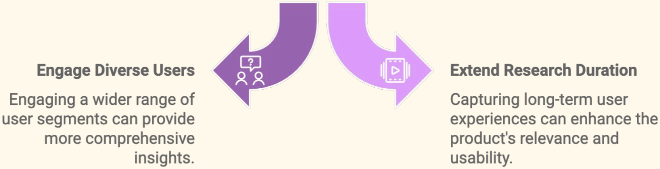
Project Success Factors


Team Collaboration
Positive Feedback
Timely Deliverables

What Could Have Been Done Differently

- More diverse user segments could have been engaged during user interviews to gather a broader range of insights.
- Initial research could have been extended to capture long-term user experiences rather than focusing solely on short-term needs.

How to improve the document generation add-on's user research?



Engage Diverse Users

Engaging a wider range of user segments can provide more comprehensive insights.

Extend Research Duration

Capturing long-term user experiences can enhance the product's relevance and usability.